SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

14 November 2024 · Shift 2

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 15 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 11 questions

Q.1

Rice worth ₹84 per kg and ₹96 per kg is mixed with a third variety of rice in the ratio 1 : 1 : 2. If the mixture is worth ₹99 per kg, the price of the third variety per kg is:

(A) ₹112
(B) ₹110
(C) ₹115
(D) ₹108

Q.4

The average of six numbers is 30. If one number is excluded, the average becomes 28. Find the excluded number.

(A) 30
(B) 35
(C) 36
(D) 40

Q.5

On selling a book for ₹348, a shopkeeper loses 13%. In order to gain 22%, he must sell that book for:

(A) ₹379
(B) ₹369
(C) ₹488
(D) ₹424

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3000 as a sum borrowed at 4% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 520
(B) 420
(C) 480
(D) 440

Q.10

Air is leaking from a spherical-shaped advertising balloon at the rate of 24 cubic feet per minute. If the radius of the balloon is 8 feet, how long would it take for the balloon to empty? Round your answer to the nearest minute. Use the approximate of value of π, that is 3.14.

(A) 94 minutes
(B) 80 minutes
(C) 89 minutes
(D) 65 minutes

Q.14

What sum (in ₹) will earn a simple interest of ₹360 in 3 years at 8% per year rate of interest?

(A) 3000
(B) 750
(C) 2000
(D) 1500

Q.15

The scale of a map is given as 1:250. Two cities are 6.5 km apart on the map. The actual distance between them is

(A) 1625 km
(B) 1250 km
(C) 1000 km
(D) 1200 km

Q.17

The average of 20, 40, 60, 80, 100, 120 and 140 is:

(A) 70
(B) 80
(C) 90
(D) 85

Q.18

The average income of 25 persons is ₹2,400 and that of another 20 persons is ₹1,500. The average income of all of them together is:

(A) ₹2,100
(B) ₹1,950
(C) ₹2,000
(D) ₹2,150

Q.19

A boat can travel at a speed of 13 km/h in still water. If the speed of the stream is 4 km/h, find the time taken by the boat to go 68 km downstream.

(A) 3 hours
(B) 5 hours
(C) 6 hours
(D) 4 hours

Q.20

If 45% of the sum of the two numbers is equal to 60% of the difference between the two numbers, find the ratio of the smallest number to the greatest number.

(A) 3 : 4
(B) 1 : 7
(C) 7 : 1
(D) 4 : 3

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 14 questions

Q.1

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13, can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) (1, 16, 5) (2, 19, 7)

(A) (3, 35, 5)
(B) (5, 20, 6)
(C) (8, 22, 4)
(D) (6, 40, 3)

Q.2

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All lions are cheetahs. Some cheetahs are tigers. Conclusions: (I) Some tigers are not cheetahs. (II) All cheetahs are lions.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.3

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? CHK, GKO, ? , OQW, STA

(A) KNT
(B) LOS
(C) KNS
(D) LOT

Q.4

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 28 – 4 × 5 + 36 ÷ 9 + 2 × 3 = 53 (Note: Interchange should be done of entire number and not individual digits of a given number)

(A) 4 and 9
(B) 5 and 3
(C) 28 and 36
(D) 2 and 9

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'CREATE' is coded as '84' and 'FLOP' is coded as '56'. What is the code for 'PURPOSEFULLY' in the given code language?

(A) 117
(B) 168
(C) 142
(D) 170

Q.9

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 16 – 4 × 2 ÷ 3 + 6= ?

(A) 8
(B) 24
(C) 12
(D) 16

Q.10

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: •All hands are legs. •Some hands are eyes. Conclusion (I): All legs are hands. Conclusion (II): Some legs are eyes.

(A) Both Conclusions I and II follow
(B) Neither Conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Only Conclusion I follows
(D) Only Conclusion II follows

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'use the force' is coded as 'gp sb cn' and 'force is strong' is coded as 'hv sk gp'. How is 'force' coded in that language?

(A) sk
(B) gp
(C) hv
(D) cn

Q.14

NKBI is related to PIDG in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, SMFG is related to UKHE. To which of the following is UPQR related, following the same logic?

(A) TRDW
(B) YGBF
(C) WNSP
(D) WRSD

Q.16

192 is related to 38 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 270 is related to 51. To which of the following is 258 related, following the same logic? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 43
(B) 46
(C) 41
(D) 49

Q.17

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 4, 7, 11, 18, 29, 47, 76, ?, 199

(A) 123
(B) 127
(C) 125
(D) 130

Q.18

M, N, O, P, Q, R and S are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). P is sitting fourth to the right of N. Q is sitting third to the left of O. M is sitting to the immediate right of Q. R is sitting to the immediate right of N. How many people are sitting between P and S when counted from the left of S?

(A) 1
(B) 2
(C) 4
(D) 3

Q.19

RQ 45 is related to TS 50 in a certain way. In the same way, UX 19 is related to WZ 24.To which of the following is CF 68 related following the same logic?

(A) EH 73
(B) NT 45
(C) NV 37
(D) ST 55

Q.20

A, B, C, L, M, Y and X are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). C sits fourth to the left of M. Only one person sits between L and Y when counted from the left of L. Only one person sits between Y and X when counted from left of Y. Only two people sit between A and Y when counted from the right of A.Who sits third to the right of B?

(A) X
(B) L
(C) A
(D) C

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

'Waiting for a Visa' is a 20-page autobiography of _____.

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Sadar Vallabhbhai Patel
(C) Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar
(D) Jawahar Lal Nehru

Q.2

Which of the following is the residential place of Buddhist priests?

(A) Stupa
(B) Chaitya
(C) Vihara
(D) Stambha

Q.3
Which of the following is an artificial port in India?

(A) Chennai port
(B) Mumbai port
(C) Deendayal port
(D) Kolkata port

Q.4
Which of the following possesses the largest isolated single cell?

(A) Human brain
(B) Blue whale
(C) Ostrich egg
(D) Amoeba

Q.5
The National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB) envisaged by the Central Government is called _____.

(A) Sahakar Mitra Scheme
(B) Seed Scheme
(C) Mission Karmayogi
(D) Seva Nidhi Scheme

Q.6
Name the Union territory with the lowest density of population as per Census of India 2011.

(A) Lakshdweep
(B) New Delhi
(C) Daman and Diu
(D) Andaman and Nicobar Islands

Q.7
Which festival commemorates the death of Hussain Ibn Ali?

(A) Milad-un-nabi
(B) Eid-ul-fitr
(C) Shab-i-baraat
(D) Muharram

Q.8
Which of the following instruments is played by Shreya Bhattacharjee, an eminent musician from Assam?

(A) Flute
(B) Violin
(C) Tabla
(D) Sitar

Q.9
Which of the following dance forms emotes a play through dancing in which the song is customarily in Manipravala language?

(A) Kathak
(B) Sattriya
(C) Mohiniattam
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.10
Which of the following Commissions was set up to investigate the incident of Jallianwala Bagh in 1919?

(A) Peel Commission
(B) Sadler Commission
(C) Simon Commission
(D) Hunter Commission

Q.11
Which of the following national income aggregates is generally recognised as National Income of a country?

(A) Gross Domestic Product at Factor Cost
(B) Net National Product at Factor Cost
(C) Gross National Product at Market Prices
(D) Net National Product at Market Prices

Q.12
In a food chain of Algae-Shrimp-Fish-Bird, if the energy available at the bird is 4 kJ, then the energy available at the shrimp is:

(A) 4 kJ
(B) 0.04 kJ
(C) 400 kJ
(D) 4000 kJ

Q.13
Who among the following has been appointed as the new Director General of the Geological Survey of India (GSI) in June 2023?

(A) Janardan Prasad
(B) Ajay Yadav
(C) Amarendu Prakash
(D) Ashwani Kumar

Q.14
According to the census of India 2011, which union territory from the following has the highest sex ratio?

(A) Puducherry
(B) Daman and Diu
(C) Lakshadweep
(D) Chandigarh

Q.15
The Directive Principles of State Policy are considered fundamental in the governance of the country, but they are not enforceable by any court. This concept is mentioned in which Article?

(A) Article 37
(B) Article 49
(C) Article 38
(D) Article 32

Q.16
From which state in India did the legendary volleyball player Jimmy George hail?

(A) Kerala
(B) Telangana
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Odisha

Q.17
Find the acceleration (in m/s^2) of a body which accelerates from 5 m/s to 10 m/s in 2 seconds.

(A) 7.5 m/sec^2
(B) 2.5 m/sec^2
(C) 5 m/sec^2
(D) 10 m/sec^2

Q.18
The Mawsynram receives the highest average annual rainfall in the world. It is located in which hills?

(A) Maikala hills
(B) Khasi hills
(C) Jaintia hills
(D) Garo hills

Q.19
Pulakeshin II was the famous ruler of which of the following dynasties?

(A) Maitraka
(B) Vakataka
(C) Chalukya
(D) Gauda

Q.20
In Maikal hills, which of the following minerals is deposited?

(A) Copper
(B) Coal
(C) Bauxite
(D) Iron

Q.21
The _____ Polo Club is the home of the Ezra Cup event, the world's oldest polo tournament, started in 1880.

(A) Hyderabad
(B) Calcutta
(C) Jaipur
(D) Delhi

Q.22
The Home Rule League Movement of Bal Gangadhar Tilak had its base across Karnataka and Maharashtra, but excluding which of the following?

(A) Nagpur
(B) Berar
(C) Bombay
(D) Poona

Q.23
For the development of agriculture, a new department, Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi was established by which of the following Sultans of Delhi?

(A) Shamsuddin Iltutmish
(B) Ghiyasuddin Balban
(C) Alauddin Khalji
(D) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq

Q.24
Who presides over the House in absence of the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker in the Indian political system?

(A) Chief Justice of the Supreme Court
(B) Prime Minister
(C) President
(D) Chairperson so nominated

Q.25
Who is the first Indian Female Dancer to receive the highest Padma award, Padma Vibhushan?

(A) Shobha Naidu
(B) Sonal Mansingh
(C) Sanjukta Panigrahi
(D) Madhavi Mudgal

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. He bought strange vintage car on auction from the customs department.

(A) on auction
(B) He bought
(C) strange vintage car
(D) from the customs department

Q.2
Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined idiom/phrase in the given sentence. The salesman informed the customers that if they had any questions, they could “drop a line”.

(A) complain against him
(B) come back with the items
(C) call his secretary
(D) send a brief letter

Q.3
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. His business was so successful that Mark was able to _____ at the age of 50.

(A) succeed
(B) admit
(C) give up
(D) retire

Q.4
Select the option with the correct spelling to replace the underlined word in the given sentence. As the roller coaster reached its highest point, a surge of “addrenalline” coursed through her veins, making her heart race with excitement.

(A) adrennaline
(B) adreneline
(C) adrenaline
(D) adrineline

Q.5
Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Wine glass is very “fragile;” you must handle it with care.

(A) Sturdy
(B) Delicate
(C) Rough
(D) Resilient

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please bring some milk from _____ refrigerator in the kitchen.

(A) an
(B) a
(C) No article required
(D) the

Q.7

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Tara has been playing / cricket with her friends / since noon.

(A) Tara has been playing
(B) Since noon
(C) Cricket with her friends
(D) No error

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. "Just when they reach" the airport, the flight had departed from the runway.

(A) After they just reach
(B) Just before they reached
(C) Just when they have reached
(D) Just they reach

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Sathish remained unwavering in the face of the assaulting gang, standing as resolute as _____.

(A) still
(B) stall
(C) steel
(D) steal

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the highlighted word. As long as I live, I shall be "obliged" to my Uncle.

(A) thankless
(B) indebted
(C) grateful
(D) pleased

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Though Amal took continuous medication, he was not able to _____ his injury.

(A) heal
(B) heel
(C) hill
(D) hail

Q.12

The following sentence has been split into four parts. Identify the part that contains a grammatical error. Surprisingly!/ dark chocolates/ are most bitterer/ in taste.

(A) Surprisingly!
(B) dark chocolates
(C) in taste.
(D) are most bitterer

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. The company's new product received "affirmative" feedback from customers.

(A) positive
(B) detailed
(C) reflective
(D) critical

Q.14

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. I had never saw/ such a sight/ before I visited Switzerland.

(A) No error
(B) I had never saw
(C) before I visited Switzerland.
(D) such a sight

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Kinetic
(B) Hektic
(C) Gentle
(D) Brilliant

Q.16

Select the option that rectifies the underlined spelling error. The "permisible" limit of vehicle speed has been increased in India by the Road Transport Corporation.

(A) permisibble
(B) parmitted
(C) permissible
(D) parmissible

Q.17

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who is mentally ill

(A) Mercenary
(B) Psychiatrist
(C) Lunatic
(D) Psychologist

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. She confided in me "on her anxious", whispering her secrets between sips of coffee.

(A) about her anxiety
(B) regarding herself's anxiousness
(C) on her anxiousness
(D) about her anxious

Q.19

Select the most appropriate phrase to replace the underlined word. She is feeling "unwell" today, so she will not be going to work.

(A) face like thunder
(B) head in the clouds
(C) under the weather
(D) chase rainbows

Q.20

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. She told me / her name but / I'm not remembering / it now.

(A) it now
(B) I'm not remembering
(C) her name but
(D) She told me

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These letters are not intended to dominate your way of thinking or to persuade you to _____ 1____ to the way the writer thinks or feels. It is really a dialogue _____ 2_____ two friends talking about their problems. You must have observed the state of our society, and that there must be a _____ 3_____ transformation in the way human beings live, their relation to each other, and in every way possible. We are deeply concerned for our students. The teacher is the _____ 4_____ important person in the school, for on her or him depends the future welfare of mankind. As the society is disintegrating, these schools must be centres for the regeneration ____ 5___ the mind.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) conform
(B) control
(C) confirm
(D) affirm

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These letters are not intended to dominate your way of thinking or to persuade you to _____ 1____ to the way the writer thinks or feels. It is really a dialogue _____ 2_____ two friends talking about their problems. You must have observed the state of our society, and that there must be a _____ 3_____ transformation in the way human beings live, their relation to each other, and in every way possible. We are deeply concerned for our students. The teacher is the _____ 4_____ important person in the school, for on her or him depends the future welfare of mankind. As the society is disintegrating, these schools must be centres for the regeneration ____ 5___ the mind.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) unless
(B) behind
(C) before
(D) between

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These letters are not intended to dominate your way of thinking or to persuade you to _____ 1____ to the way the writer thinks or feels. It is really a dialogue _____ 2_____ two friends talking about their problems. You must have observed the state of our society, and that there must be a _____ 3_____ transformation in the way human beings live, their relation to each other, and in every way possible. We are deeply concerned for our students. The teacher is the _____ 4_____ important person in the school, for on her or him depends the future welfare of mankind. As the society is disintegrating, these schools must be centres for the regeneration ____ 5___ the mind.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) highly
(B) radical
(C) radial
(D) avoidable

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These letters are not intended to dominate your way of thinking or to persuade you to _____ 1____ to the way the writer thinks or feels. It is really a dialogue _____ 2_____ two friends talking about their problems. You must have observed the state of our society, and that there must be a _____ 3_____ transformation in the way human beings live, their relation to each other, and in every way possible. We are deeply concerned for our students. The teacher is the _____ 4_____ important person in the school, for on her or him depends the future welfare of mankind. As the society is disintegrating, these schools must be centres for the regeneration ____ 5___ the mind.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) most
(B) much
(C) more
(D) not

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. These letters are not intended to dominate your way of thinking or to persuade you to _____ 1____ to the way the writer thinks or feels. It is really a dialogue _____ 2_____ two friends talking about their problems. You must have observed the state of our society, and that there must be a _____ 3_____ transformation in the way human beings live, their relation to each other, and in every way possible. We are deeply concerned for our students. The teacher is the _____ 4_____ important person in the school, for on her or him depends the future welfare of mankind. As the society is disintegrating, these schools must be centres for the regeneration ____ 5___ the mind.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) off
(B) of
(C) although
(D) under

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**
Q.10 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**				

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (D) ₹108

With the third variety at ₹x: (84 + 96 + 2x)/4 = 99, so 180 + 2x = 396 and x = ₹108.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 40

The six numbers add up to 6 × 30 = 180 and the remaining five to 5 × 28 = 140, so the excluded number is 40.

Q.5 · Answer (C) ₹488

₹348 is 87% of the cost price, so CP = ₹400. A 22% gain needs 1.22 × 400 = ₹488.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 480

SI = 3000 × 4 × 4/100 = ₹480.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 89 minutes

Volume = (4/3) × 3.14 × 8^3 = 2,143.57 cubic feet. At 24 cubic feet a minute it empties in 2,143.57/24 ≈ 89.3, about 89 minutes.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 1500

P = SI × 100/(R × T) = 360 × 100/(8 × 3) = ₹1,500.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 1625 km

On a 1:250 scale each unit on the map stands for 250 on the ground: 6.5 km × 250 = 1625 km.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 80

The seven numbers add up to 560, and 560/7 = 80 (the middle term of an evenly spaced list).

Q.18 · Answer (C) ₹2,000

Total income = 25 × 2,400 + 20 × 1,500 = 60,000 + 30,000 = ₹90,000 for 45 persons: ₹2,000 each.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 4 hours

Downstream speed = 13 + 4 = 17 km/h, so 68 km takes 68/17 = 4 hours.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 1 : 7

0.45(a + b) = 0.6(a − b) gives 45a + 45b = 60a − 60b, so 105b = 15a and a = 7b. Smaller : greater = 1 : 7.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (C) (8, 22, 4)

The middle number is the sum of the other two plus 10: 1 + 5 + 10 = 16 and 2 + 7 + 10 = 19. Likewise 8 + 4 + 10 = 22.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Some cheetahs are tigers, but nothing says whether any tiger lies outside the cheetahs (I), and all lions being cheetahs does not make all cheetahs lions (II). Neither follows.

Q.3 · Answer (C) KNS

First letters move +4 (C, G, K, O, S), second letters +3 (H, K, N, Q, T) and third letters +4 (K, O, S, W, A): KNS.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 2 and 9

Interchanging 2 and 9: 28 − 4 × 5 + 36 ÷ 2 + 9 × 3 = 28 − 20 + 18 + 27 = 53.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 168

Each word's code is 14 times its number of letters: CREATE (6) = 84 and FLOP (4) = 56. PURPOSEFULLY has 12 letters: 12 × 14 = 168.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 16

After interchanging the signs: 16 + 4 ÷ 2 × 3 − 6 = 16 + 6 − 6 = 16.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Only Conclusion II follows
The hands that are eyes are also legs, so some legs are eyes (II). All hands being legs does not make all legs hands (I). Only II follows.

Q.12 · Answer (B) gp
'force' is the only word in both sentences and 'gp' the only code in both, so force = gp.

Q.14 · Answer (C) WNSP
The letters move +2, –2, +2, –2: NKBI → PIDG and SMFG → UKHE. So UPQR → WNSP.

Q.16 · Answer (D) 49
The second number is the first divided by 6, plus 6: 192 ÷ 6 + 6 = 38 and 270 ÷ 6 + 6 = 51. Likewise 258 ÷ 6 + 6 = 49.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 123
Each term is the sum of the two before it: 47 + 76 = 123, and then 76 + 123 = 199.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 1
Going round to the right from N the order is N, R, Q, M, P, O, S: P is fourth to N's right, R next to N, and Q (with M on its right) third to O's left. Counting from S to its left, only O comes before P: 1 person.

Q.19 · Answer (A) EH 73
Both letters move 2 places forward and the number rises by 5: RQ 45 → TS 50 and UX 19 → WZ 24. So CF 68 → EH 73.

Q.20 · Answer (C) A
Y is two seats to L's left and X two seats to Y's left; Y is three seats to A's right, and C four seats to M's left. Going round to the right from L: L, M, A, X, C, Y, B. Third to the right of B is A.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar
'Waiting for a Visa' is B. R. Ambedkar's short autobiographical account of the untouchability he faced.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Vihara
A vihara was a monastery where Buddhist monks lived; a chaitya was a prayer hall and a stupa a mound over relics.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Chennai port
Chennai is one of India's oldest artificial ports. Mumbai is a natural harbour, Kolkata a riverine port and Deendayal (Kandla) a tidal port.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Ostrich egg
An unfertilised ostrich egg is the usual example of the largest single cell; a brain and a whale are made of many cells, and an amoeba is a tiny single cell.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Mission Karmayogi
Mission Karmayogi, approved by the Union Cabinet in 2020, is the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
In the 2011 Census the Andaman and Nicobar Islands had the lowest population density of the Union territories, 46 persons per km².

Q.7 · Answer (D) Muharram
Muharram, above all Ashura, its tenth day, mourns the martyrdom of Husain ibn Ali, the Prophet's grandson, at Karbala in 680 AD.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Tabla
Shreya Bhattacharjee, a young tabla player from Assam, received the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar (art and culture) in 2023.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Mohiniattam
Mohiniyattam, Kerala's classical dance, is performed to songs in Manipravalam, a blend of Malayalam and Sanskrit.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Hunter Commission
The Hunter Committee (the Disorders Inquiry Committee), set up in October 1919, inquired into the Jallianwala Bagh massacre.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Net National Product at Factor Cost
National income is the Net National Product at factor cost.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 400 kJ
By the ten per cent law only about a tenth of the energy passes to the next level, so going down the chain: bird 4 kJ, fish 40 kJ, shrimp 400 kJ.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Janardan Prasad
Janardan Prasad took charge as Director General of the Geological Survey of India in June 2023, succeeding S. Raju.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Puducherry
In the 2011 Census Puducherry had the highest sex ratio of the Union territories, 1,037 females per 1,000 males.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Article 37
Article 37 says the Directive Principles shall not be enforceable by any court but are fundamental in the governance of the country.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Kerala
Jimmy George, the volleyball player, came from Peravoor in Kannur district, Kerala.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 2.5 m/sec²
$a = (v - u)/t = (10 - 5)/2 = 2.5\ m/s^2$.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Khasi hills
Mawsynram lies in the East Khasi Hills district of Meghalaya.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Chalukya
Pulakeshin II was the greatest king of the Chalukyas of Badami; he halted Harsha's advance at the Narmada.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Bauxite
NCERT names the Amarkantak plateau, the Maikal hills and the Bilaspur-Katni plateau as important bauxite areas.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Calcutta
The Calcutta Polo Club, set up in the 1860s and among the oldest polo clubs in the world, is the home of the Ezra Cup.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Bombay
Tilak's Home Rule League, founded at Belgaum in April 1916, worked in Maharashtra (except Bombay city), Karnataka, the Central Provinces and Berar; Annie Besant's league covered the rest of India.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
Muhammad bin Tughlaq set up the Diwan-i-Amir-Kohi, a department of agriculture, to bring more land under cultivation.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Chairperson so nominated
When both the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker are absent, a member of the panel of chairpersons nominated by the Speaker presides over the Lok Sabha.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Sonal Mansingh
SSC's key gives Sonal Mansingh, who received the Padma Vibhushan in 2003 and is the only one of the four to have received it. Strictly she was the second woman dancer to receive it, after T. Balasaraswati in 1977.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) strange vintage car
SSC's key gives 'strange vintage car': 'car' is a singular countable noun and needs an article, 'a strange vintage car'. ('At auction' is the more usual phrase, but 'on auction' is also met, so the missing article is the clear error.)

Q.2 · Answer (D) send a brief letter
To 'drop (someone) a line' is to send a short letter or note.

Q.3 · Answer (D) retire
His success let Mark 'retire', stop working, at 50.

Q.4 · Answer (C) adrenaline
The correct spelling is 'adrenaline'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Delicate
'Fragile' means easily broken: 'delicate'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) the
A particular refrigerator, the one in the kitchen, takes the definite article 'the'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) No error
The present perfect continuous with 'since' and a point of time is correct: 'Tara has been playing cricket with her friends since noon.'

Q.8 · Answer (B) Just before they reached
The earlier action takes the past perfect and the later one the simple past: 'Just before they reached the airport, the flight had departed.'

Q.9 · Answer (C) steel
'As resolute as steel' compares firmness to steel; 'steal' (to rob), 'still' and 'stall' do not fit.

Q.10 · Answer (A) thankless
To be 'obliged' is to be grateful; its opposite is 'thankless', ungrateful.

Q.11 · Answer (A) heal
To 'heal' an injury is to make it well; 'heel' (part of the foot), 'hill' and 'hail' only sound alike.

Q.12 · Answer (D) are most bitterer
'Most bitterer' is a double comparison: 'are more bitter' (or 'most bitter').

Q.13 · Answer (A) positive
'Affirmative' feedback is 'positive' feedback.

Q.14 · Answer (B) I had never saw
'Had' takes the past participle: 'I had never seen such a sight'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Hektic
The correct spelling is 'hectic'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) permissible
The correct spelling is 'permissible'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Lunatic
'Lunatic' (an old word, now considered offensive) means a mentally ill person; a psychiatrist and a psychologist treat the mind, and a mercenary is a soldier for hire.

Q.18 · Answer (A) about her anxiety
One confides in someone 'about' something, and after 'her' a noun is needed: 'She confided in me about her anxiety.'

Q.19 · Answer (C) under the weather
To be 'under the weather' is to feel slightly unwell.

Q.20 · Answer (B) I'm not remembering
'Remember' is a stative verb and is not used in the continuous: 'I don't remember it now.'

Q.21 · Answer (A) conform
To 'conform to' is to fall in with: the letters do not ask you to think as the writer does. 'Confirm' only looks similar.

Q.22 · Answer (D) between
A dialogue is 'between' two people: 'a dialogue between two friends'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) radical
A 'radical' transformation is a thorough, fundamental one; 'radial' only looks similar.

Q.24 · Answer (A) most
The superlative: 'the most important person in the school'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) of
'The regeneration of the mind': the preposition 'of'.

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